

// Day 25 of 30

8 HABITS

What Senior Devs Do Differently in Code Reviews

→ Swipe through all 6 slides



Shubham Bhati

[linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham)

1/8

They Read the PR Description First

Context before code

Junior: Jumps straight to code

Senior: Reads WHY first

- What problem does this solve?
- What was the approach?
- What alternatives were considered?

Without context, you're reviewing
syntax, not solutions.

💡 Always write PR descriptions. Always read them.



Shubham Bhati

[linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham)

They Check the Tests First

Tests tell the story

Senior reviewer's first click:

→ test files

Why?

- Tests show WHAT the code should do
- Edge cases reveal thinking depth
- No tests? That's the first comment.

'The tests are the documentation
that never goes stale.'

💡 No tests = incomplete PR. Always.



Shubham Bhati

linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham

They Ask Questions, Not Commands

Coaching > criticizing

Junior reviewer:

'This is wrong. Use HashMap.'

Senior reviewer:

'What was the reason for choosing
TreeMap here? HashMap might be
faster for this use case – curious
about your thinking.'

- Same feedback
- Completely different impact

💡 Questions teach. Commands frustrate.



Shubham Bhati

[linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham)

They Look for Missing Code

What's NOT there matters more

Senior checks for:

- Error handling missing?
- Input validation skipped?
- Edge case not covered?
- Logging absent?
- Index not created for new query?

Junior checks for:

- Variable naming
- Formatting
- Style issues

💡 Missing code causes production bugs. Style doesn't.



Shubham Bhati

linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham

They Think About Production

Will this survive real traffic?

Questions seniors ask:

- What happens at 1000 req/sec?
- What if the DB is slow?
- What if this service is down?
- Is this query N+1?
- Will this lock the table?
- What's the rollback plan?

💡 Code that works $\neq$ code that survives production



Shubham Bhati

linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham

They Approve With Trust

Perfectionism kills velocity

Junior reviewer: 15 nit comments

- Blocks PR for 3 days
- Team velocity drops

Senior reviewer:

- 2-3 meaningful comments
- 'Approve with suggestions'
- Trusts author to iterate

Ship > Perfect
(for non-critical code)

💡 Block only for: bugs, security, architecture. Rest = suggest.



Shubham Bhati

linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham

done = true

Follow for more!

Like · Comment · Repost

Shubham Bhati

[linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham)



Shubham Bhati

[linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhatishubham)